

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, a thick cloud cover, a shower will be possible, high 59. **Tonight**, cloudy, a little evening rain, low 44. **Tomorrow**, partly sunny, breezy, high 60. Weather map, Page A20.

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SATURDAY, MAY 2, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00

SIGN-UPS PLUNGE FOR OBAMACARE AS PRICES SOAR

MILLIONS DROP PLANS

Many Can’t Afford Cost After Congress Lets Enhanced Aid End

By REED ABELSON
and MARGOT SANGER-KATZ

Millions of Americans appear to be dropping Obamacare coverage in the months since Congress failed to extend the generous subsidies that had become a defining feature of the Affordable Care Act.

Initial sign-ups had already fallen by about 1.2 million people. But insurance companies, state officials and industry analysts are reporting that many more have lost Obamacare coverage now that people are facing long-term higher costs. The federal government has yet to report current enrollment data.

Many insurers and analysts are estimating overall declines of about 20 percent, dropping to around 19 million from the 24 million who were covered under the A.C.A. last year. Other indications suggest there could be even larger potential losses by the end of the year, a deep retrenchment for Obamacare coverage and a reversal of significant gains in the last several years.

The rising cost of health care has shown up in several public opinion polls as a top concern among Americans. Premiums are also rising for Americans who get insurance through work, as health care costs have been increasing nationwide. Out-of-pocket costs are growing, too, as plans with high deductibles have become popular.

Though health care has faded somewhat as a priority for the Republican-controlled Congress since lawmakers hit a stalemate over the subsidies at the end of 2025, it is likely to figure prominently in the midterm elections this year.

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Jews in Politics Confront Wave Of Antagonism

Antisemitism Rises as Israel’s Support Falls

By JENNIFER MEDINA

It had been less than a month since Noah Arbit’s childhood synagogue in West Bloomfield, Mich., was attacked by a man who rammed a truck through the entrance, forcing dozens of staff members and preschool children to flee the burning building. A letter he received left him outraged, and horrified.

“Let’s remember Jews brought this all upon themselves,” it read.

The letter, which was anonymous, denounced Israel’s treatment of Palestinians in Gaza and in the Israeli-occupied West Bank and then criticized a long list of well-known Jewish people.

Mr. Arbit, a Michigan state legislator who represents heavily Jewish suburbs of Detroit, had made fighting antisemitism a core to his platform since his first campaign in 2022. Critics had dismissed his concerns as overblown, he said, but now “there is a proof point I never wanted to be there.”

Across the country, at all levels of government, Jewish officeholders and candidates for public office — a majority of whom are Democrats — are facing a singular moment in recent history. At a time when incidents of antisemitism in the United States have risen sharply, Jewish politicians say they frequently find themselves personally targeted, according to interviews with nearly two dozen elected officials. They have faced antisemitic slurs and menacing voice mail messages, including threats of assassination. Protesters have called members of Congress “dirty Jews” during town hall events and thrown red liquid — meant to look like blood — on their front lawns.

The heightened antagonism has grown since Israel began its military campaign in Gaza in response to the Hamas-led attack on Israel, killing more than 70,000 people, according to the Gaza

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In Iran, Cafes Providing Coffee And an Escape One Can Afford

By FARNAZ FASSIHI

Three weeks into a fragile cease-fire with the United States, Iranians are seeking to reclaim fragments of normal life. For many eager to connect with one another, cafes have emerged as the focal point of social gatherings in Tehran and many other Iranian cities.

Men and women, young and old, pack the coffee shops that dot the sprawling capital. Friends, families and colleagues crowd tables and bar stools and spill onto the sidewalks. They gather at all hours of the day and late into the night. They sip espressos, cappuccinos and Persian tea infused with cardamom. Sometimes, they share a piece of cake. These are tough economic times and many people have been laid off. Many say they are running through their savings as they struggle with a collapsing currency and rampant inflation.

But a cup of coffee is still affordable and cafes provide escape, if only for a few fleeting hours, said a dozen Iranians who frequent them. Cafes allow Iranians a place to collectively process the five weeks of war with the United States.

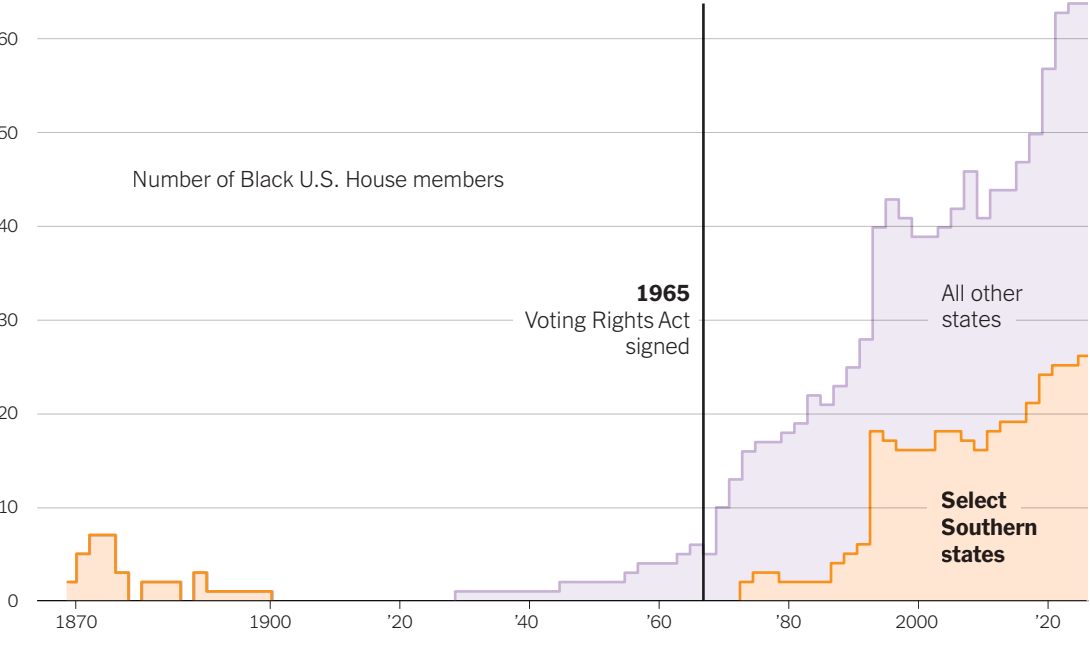
Continued on Page A12



Men and women, young and old, pack the cafes in Tehran.

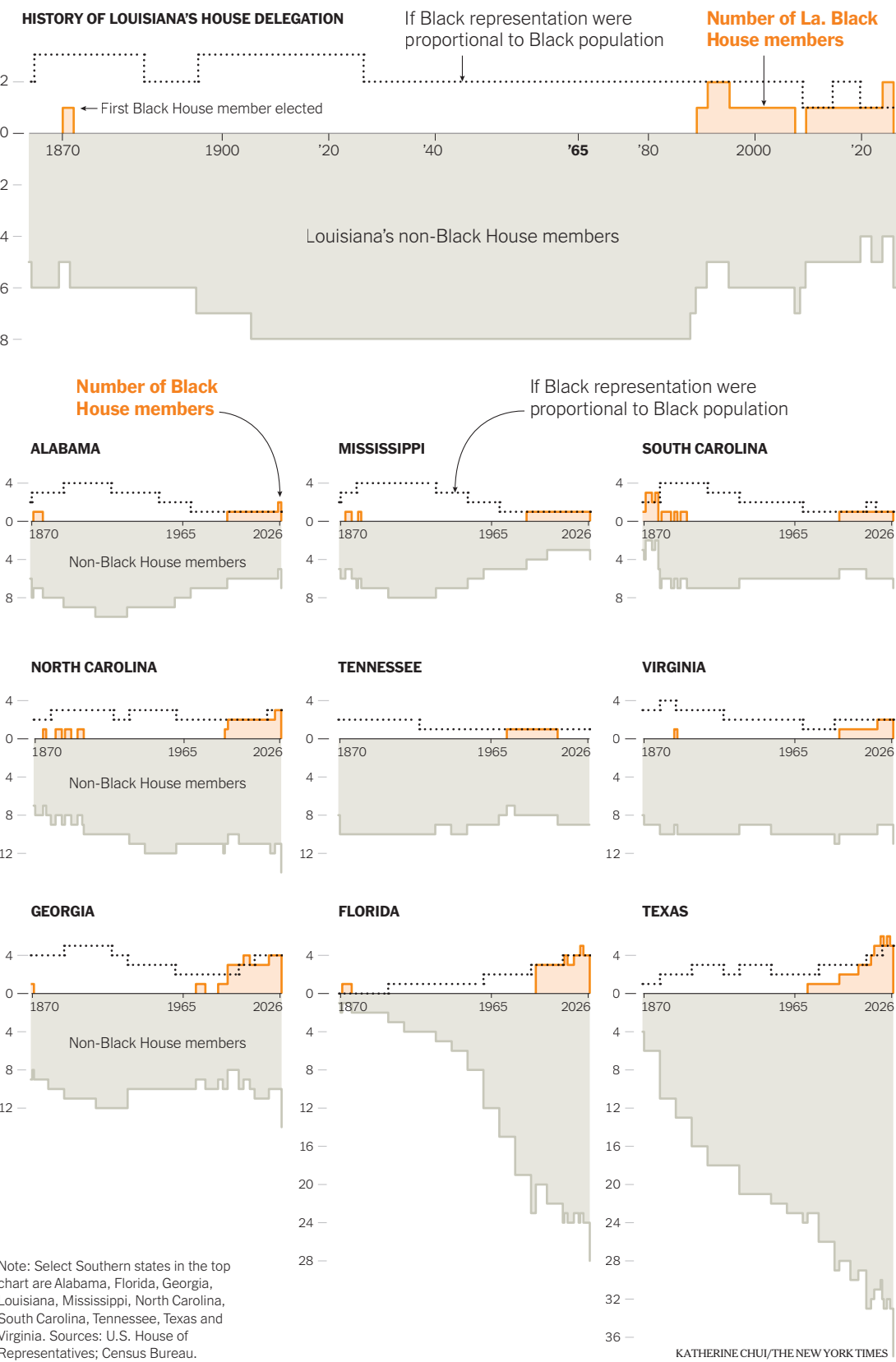
A Voting Rights Legacy

The number of Black lawmakers in the U.S. House dramatically increased after the Voting Rights Act of 1965 went into effect. Here is a closer look at how the measure, which was dealt a blow on Wednesday by a Supreme Court ruling, changed Black representation in Southern states. Page A16.



An Increase in Black Lawmakers

It took more than a century for Black delegations to reach their share of the Black population in these states.



Bard President Steps Down After Revelations About Epstein Ties

By VIMAL PATEL

The president of Bard College, an unorthodox liberal-arts school in New York, announced his retirement on Friday, after running the school for more than a half century.

The president, Leon Botstein, was known for his fund-raising prowess and outsize personality, but came under scrutiny after the release of documents that showed he had a closer relationship with Jeffrey Epstein than previously known.

In 2021, the billionaire George

Dr. Botstein has long maintained that his relationship with Mr. Epstein was entirely about coaxing him to give money to the school, which is about 100 miles north of New York City.

Dr. Botstein became president of Bard in 1975, when he was only 28 years old and the college was in dire financial shape. He earned a reputation as a talented fundraiser, and is credited by his supporters with keeping Bard afloat at a time when many colleges are facing difficulties and some have closed.

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titution. In one 2013 note, Dr. Botstein signed off with “Miss you.” He spoke of his cherished “new friendship” with the financier, and wished him well after the publication of news article that detailed his abuse.

The new documents did not show any criminal wrongdoing on Dr. Botstein’s part, but Dr. Botstein is the latest powerful person to leave a top position after their communications with Mr. Epstein were revealed.

The college commissioned an

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NATIONAL A1-21

A.I. Backlash Gathers Steam

The movement is pulling in people from all walks of life, united by a worry that Big Tech will cash in while average Americans bear the costs. PAGE A18

A Bleak Side to a Boom

San Antonio’s rapid expansion brought new jobs, but decades of low wages have kept many residents from reaching the middle class. PAGE A13

Lessons at Justice Dept.

In naming only an interim successor as acting attorney general, President Trump has established greater incentives to execute his demands. PAGE A15

ARTS C1-8

As a Heroine, Adding Depth

The soprano Asmik Grigorian is starring as Tatiana in “Eugene Onegin” at the Metropolitan Opera. PAGE C1

Presidential, and Artistic, Too

Barack and Michelle Obama commissioned 30 artists to create work for their new center in Chicago. PAGE C1



INTERNATIONAL A4-12

Taiwan, China and Paraguay

Beijing is trying to unravel an unlikely long-distance relationship that has endured for decades. Could Paraguay be tempted to stray? PAGE A4

Perilous Choice for Sheinbaum

The Trump administration wants Mexico’s president to arrest one of her own governors over a cartel. PAGE A9

Settling Into Tourist Mode

After losing her legs, a New York Times food writer faces her fears and rediscovered her home city. PAGE C10

BUSINESS B1-6

Stocks Stay on a Roll

The S&P 500 notched five weeks of gains for the first time in roughly 18 months. In April, the index rose more than 10 percent, its best month since November 2020. PAGE B1

Spirit Prepares to Shut Down

The low-fare airline, which reshaped aviation in the U.S. but has since struggled, had been trying in recent weeks to secure a \$500 million lifeline from the Trump administration. PAGE B1

Robinson Meyer

OPINION A22-23 PAGE A22



His Quest for the Roses

Mike Repole, a billionaire and passionate St. John’s supporter, seeks his first Kentucky Derby win as he looks to transform horse racing. PAGE B7

